HEAD-TO-HEAD COMPARISON

AccuKnox vs HashiCorp Vault

AccuKnox Secrets Manager and HashiCorp Vault compared across Vault API compatibility, multi-tenancy, secret engines, authentication, audit and SIEM, runtime hardening, compliance, Kubernetes delivery, high availability and deployment options.

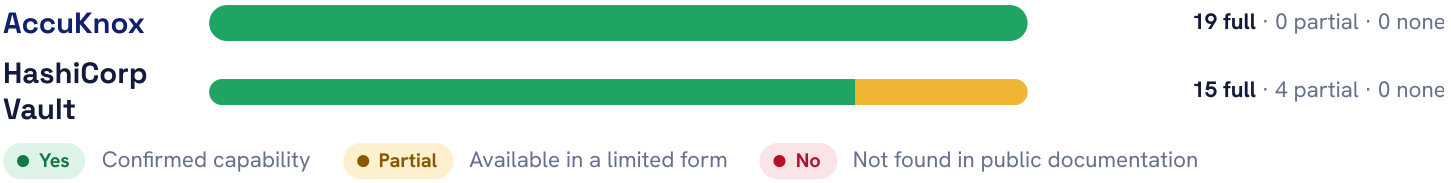
AccuKnox documents 19 of 19 capabilities in full. HashiCorp Vault documents 15.



SUMMARY

19 capabilities compared

AccuKnox leads on 4 rows, matches HashiCorp Vault on 15 and trails on 0.



Yes Confirmed capability · Partial Available in a limited form · No Not found in public documentation

Where AccuKnox is different

01 Keep the Vault API
API-compatible with HashiCorp Vault, so existing apps, scripts and tooling keep working with no major code changes.



02 Namespaces in the product
Every tenant gets a separate namespace with its own permissions, resources and configuration.



03 Audit logs that reach your SIEM
Every request is logged, and dedicated instances integrate directly with AccuKnox SIEM and CDR.



04 Hardened at runtime
AccuKnox CWPP, built on KubeArmor, limits what processes in each Secrets Manager pod can read and run.



05 Air-gapped on your terms
Install from an internal registry with no internet access, or run a dedicated instance on-prem or air-gapped.



A Platform and Compatibility

3 capabilities

CAPABILITY	ACCUKNOX	HASHICORP VAULT
01 **Vault API Compatibility**	Yes API-compatible with HashiCorp Vault. Existing apps, scripts and tooling keep working with no major code changes.	Yes Defines the Vault HTTP API that AccuKnox Secrets Manager matches.
02 **Multi-Tenancy and Namespaces**	Yes Each tenant gets a separate namespace with its own permissions, resources and configuration. Dedicated instances support several namespaces.	Partial Namespaces need a Vault Enterprise license or an HCP Vault Dedicated cluster.
03 **Air-Gapped and On-Prem Deployment**	Yes Install from an internal registry with no internet access, or run a dedicated instance on-prem or air-gapped. LDAP sign-in works offline.	Partial Vault Enterprise is self-managed for hybrid and on-premises estates. The page does not describe an air-gapped install.

AccuKnox docs: Overview Architecture Air-Gapped Deployment

B Secrets and Encryption Engines

6 capabilities

CAPABILITY	ACCUKNOX	HASHICORP VAULT
04 **Versioned KV Secrets**	● Yes KV version 1 and 2 engines hold static secrets, with versions and rollback in version 2.	● Yes The KV secrets engine stores static secrets, and version 2 keeps versions of each key.
05 **Encryption as a Service (Transit)**	● Yes The Transit engine encrypts and decrypts values through the API, so apps never hold the key.	● Yes The Transit secrets engine handles cryptographic functions on data in transit.
06 **Certificate Issuance (PKI)**	● Yes The PKI engine issues certificates through the same API and policies.	● Yes The PKI secrets engine generates dynamic X.509 certificates.
07 **Dynamic Database Credentials**	● Yes The Database engine issues short-lived database credentials.	● Yes The database secrets engine generates database credentials dynamically.
08 **Dynamic Cloud and Kubernetes Credentials**	● Yes Dynamic secrets cover AWS and Kubernetes with short-lived credentials.	● Yes Separate AWS and Kubernetes secrets engines generate credentials on demand.
09 **TOTP and SSH Engines**	● Yes The TOTP engine generates and validates 6-digit codes under policy control. An SSH engine issues one-time passwords.	● Yes The TOTP engine generates and validates time-based codes. The SSH engine covers one-time SSH passwords.

AccuKnox docs: Storing secrets in the KV engine Encryption as a Service TOTP Authenticator

C Authentication and Access

3 capabilities

CAPABILITY	ACCUKNOX	HASHICORP VAULT
10 **Identity Provider Sign-In**	● Yes People sign in with OIDC (for example Microsoft Entra ID), LDAP, Okta, or a username and password.	● Yes JWT/OIDC, LDAP and Okta auth methods connect people to an identity provider.
11 **Workload and Machine Identity**	● Yes Pods use a Kubernetes service account. VMs, jobs and scripts use AppRole, a TLS certificate or JWT.	● Yes AppRole and Kubernetes auth methods cover machines and pods.
12 **Per-Path Access Policies**	● Yes A policy limits each application or teammate to its own paths. A token keeps its old policies until the holder logs in again.	● Yes ACL policies limit access within Vault and inside each namespace.

AccuKnox docs: Architecture Sharing Secrets in an Organisation

D Audit, Compliance and Hardening

4 capabilities

CAPABILITY	ACCUKNOX	HASHICORP VAULT
13 **Audit Logging**	● Yes Every request is logged, allowed or denied, and the logs are ready for your SIEM.	● Yes Audit devices record API requests and responses. Auditing stays off until you enable a device.
14 **Audit Logs Into SIEM and CDR**	● Yes Dedicated instances integrate directly with AccuKnox SIEM and CDR.	● Partial Audit devices write to a file, a syslog server or a socket.
15 **Runtime Hardening of the Server**	● Yes AccuKnox CWPP, built on KubeArmor, hardens every Secrets Manager pod at runtime. It limits what processes in the pods can read and run.	● Partial Vault publishes baseline and extended production hardening recommendations. Your team applies them.
16 **Compliance Reporting**	● Yes Real-time audit logs, compliance reporting and a dashboard for secrets health and status.	● Yes Vault Enterprise lists multi-level access controls, customizable audit logs, and FIPS 140-2 and SOC 2 support.

AccuKnox docs: Architecture Overview

E Delivery and Operations

3 capabilities

CAPABILITY	ACCUKNOX	HASHICORP VAULT
17 **Kubernetes Delivery**	● Yes The Agent Injector and External Secrets Operator deliver secrets to pods, and the Operator needs no app code change.	● Yes Vault Enterprise lists OpenShift OLM, sidecar injection, a CSI provider and Vault Operator.
18 **High Availability and Backup**	● Yes Three nodes run in high availability mode on all instances. A snapshot agent saves to S3-compatible storage every 15 minutes by default.	● Yes Vault runs multiple servers in high availability mode to protect against outages.
19 **Managed Instances**	● Yes Shared or dedicated managed instances in North America, Europe, the Middle East and India.	● Yes HCP Vault Dedicated is the hosted option.

AccuKnox docs: External Secrets Operator Direct SDK and REST API High Availability and Backup Deployment Guide

How we scored

- **Yes** means the vendor documents the capability. **Partial** means it exists in a limited form. **No** means we found no native capability in public documentation.
- AccuKnox ratings come from help.accuknox.com. Competitor ratings come from the vendors' own documentation and product pages, listed below. Reviewed October 2026.
- Vendors ship changes often. If a rating no longer matches your version of a product, tell us and we will update it.

Competitor sources

HashiCorp Vault

- Vault API documentation
- Namespaces and secure multi-tenancy
- Audit logging
- Production hardening
- High availability
- Vault Enterprise
- KV secrets engine
- Transit secrets engine
- PKI secrets engine
- Database secrets engine
- AWS secrets engine
- TOTP secrets engine
- JWT/OIDC auth method
- AppRole auth method

See it on your stack

Run AccuKnox next to HashiCorp Vault on your own code, clusters and registries. Book a demo at **accuknox.com**. Product documentation lives at **help.accuknox.com**.